

Titles

Italic type is used to write the titles of long works, such as books, journals, movies, or musical compositions. Shorter works, such as poems or short stories, are written in quotation marks. The names of ships should also be italicized.

Big Beach Splash! ← movie title

Surfing is Simple ← book title

Italicize	Do not italicize
titles of printed matter such as books, newspapers, journals, magazines, very long poems, and plays	- the name of a holy book such as the Bible or the Koran - chapters within a book, articles in a newspaper or magazine, titles of short stories or poems—put these in quotation marks
titles of movies, and radio and television programs	individual episodes of a radio or television program—put these in quotation marks
names of specific ships, submarines, aircraft, spacecraft, and artificial satellites	- the abbreviations before a ship's name: RMS <i>Titanic</i>, USS <i>Arizona</i> - a brand of vehicle: Rolls-Royce, Boeing 747 - names of trains
long musical compositions such as albums and operas	titles of songs and short compositions—put these in quotation marks
works of art, such as paintings and sculptures	buildings and monuments: the Empire State Building, the Statue of Liberty

book *Surfing is Simple*, but about surfing, is *much* better.

Emphasis

Italics can be used when a writer wants to emphasize certain words or draw attention to a contrast between two terms. They may also indicate that the word or phrase should be given greater emphasis when spoken.

The movie is *much* better.

This word has been italicized to emphasize how much better the speaker thinks the movie about surfing is, compared to the book.

This style is called **italic** because it was first used in **Italy** in **1501**.



• When **writing by hand** or typing with a device that does not have italics, underline the word or phrase instead.